Either way, we might end up purging from the cache data that is used frequently, on average, over time, just because there might be fresher data, entries that have been accessed more recently, but perhaps will never ever (or for a long time, longer than the average life of a cache entry) be accessed again.

If that's a possibility, an alternative policy could be based on counting how many times an entry has been accessed since it was added to the cache, and always retain those items that are accessed the most.

This purging strategy is called *LFU* for **l**east **f**requently **u**sed (sometimes also referred to as *MFU*, **m**ost **f**requently **u**sed) and comes with the advantage that items that are stored in the cache and never accessed again get purged out of the cache fairly quickly[23].

